CREATIVE VIDEO TIPS · DAVINCI RESOLVE

LTX Alpha Gen Guide

Guide v1.06 · November 7, 2026 · LTX Alpha Gen 1.49

Local, stable AI roto for DaVinci Resolve. Free, on your Mac. LTX Alpha Gen is an OpenFX plugin that makes an alpha matte for a clip with Lightricks' LTX-2.5 Alpha Gen model. It runs on your Mac's GPU, in Resolve and Fusion Studio.

creative VIDEOTIPS

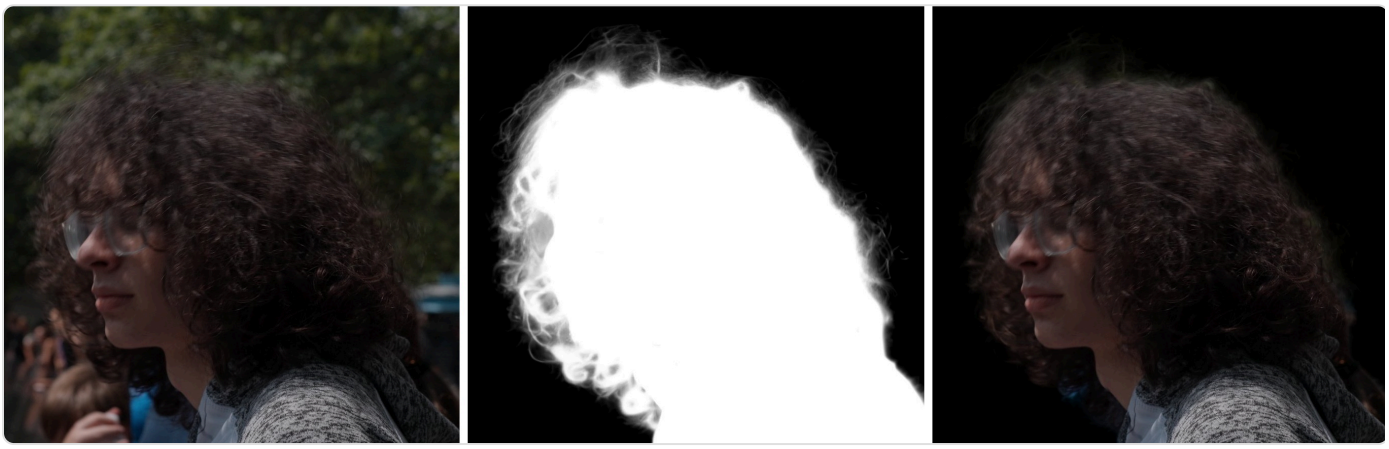
1. Install
The plugin, then the models

2. Process
Press one button and wait

3. Use the matte
Grade the subject or cut it out

Should you use it?

Try Magic Mask first. Resolve's Magic Mask is far faster, so use it first. When its matte isn't good enough, use LTX Alpha Gen for the more precise work.



One frame of curly hair: the source, the matte and the cut-out

Fine detail is where it earns its time: on this frame the matte follows individual curls and flyaway strands.

What your Mac needs

- **Apple Silicon only.** There is no Windows, Linux or NVIDIA version.
- **macOS 15 (Sequoia) or later.** The installer will not install on an older macOS.
- **128 GB of RAM recommended; not recommended on 64 GB or less.** The model alone holds about 41 GB of the GPU's memory, however small the clip, and on a 64 GB Mac macOS leaves

little more than that. One M1 Max with 64 GB ran it in Fusion Studio with nothing else open; an M2 Max with 64 GB could not load the model.

- **Disk space:** see the table below.
- **Apple's Command Line Tools,** a free download from Apple (Install). You don't need to install Python: Setup brings its own.
- **Resolve Studio or Fusion Studio.** It is tested with both, and not yet with the free version of Resolve. Magic Mask is Studio-only, but any roto or garbage matte works for Guided ROI.

Every Mac downloads the same files, about 75 GB. At the end of Setup, the plugin tests whether a second copy of the main model would run faster on your chip. If so, it adds one, which takes another 42 GB.

Mac	Extra copy?	Model Folder	Free space to allow
M1 family	Yes, about 2x faster (measured on an M1 Max)	about 117 GB	about 125 GB
M2 family	Yes (folder size measured on an M2 Max)	about 117 GB	about 125 GB
M3, M4 families	Not measured yet	about 75 or 117 GB	about 125 GB to be safe
M5 family	No, same speed (measured on an M5 Max)	about 75 GB	about 80 GB

How long it takes

Mac	Job	Time
M5 Max, 128 GB	176 HD frames in Resolve	about 31 min
M5 Max, 128 GB	176 frames with a 512×576 Guided ROI crop, in Fusion Studio	about 4.3 min
M5 Max, 128 GB	63 HD frames with Frame Hold Off, 2x, 4x	about 9, 17, 35 min
M1 Max, 64 GB	33 HD frames in Fusion Studio	about 32 min

An M5 Ultra with 128 GB of RAM may be up to about twice as fast as an M5 Max. That is an estimate: nobody has run one yet. The GPU stays busy during a job, so playback is slow until it finishes.

Install

1. **Install Apple's Command Line Tools,** if you don't have them. In Terminal, run this and follow the window it opens. If it says they are already installed, carry on.

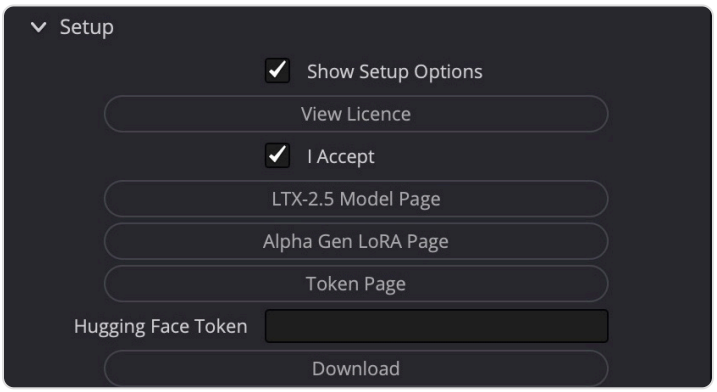
```
xcode-select --install
```

2. **Install the plugin.** Quit Resolve and Fusion Studio, then double-click `LTXAlphaGen-<version>.pkg`. It asks for your admin password.
3. **Start Resolve.** The node is on the Fusion page under Effects > OpenFX > Creative Video Tips > LTX Alpha Gen.

Setup: download the models

The installer is only the plugin. The models are a separate download from Hugging Face, and Lightricks asks each person to accept their terms, so you need a free Hugging Face account.

Add the node to a comp and open its **Setup** section. The controls run in the order you use them, top to bottom.



1. Press **View Licence**, then tick **I Accept**. The LTX-2.x Community License is free below USD 10M annual revenue. Above that, a paid Lightricks licence is required.
2. Press **LTX-2.5 Model Page**. Log in or sign up, and accept the terms in the box near the top of the page. Access is granted at once, with no waiting.
3. Press **Alpha Gen LoRA Page** and accept the terms there too. If you miss one, Download stops with "Hugging Face refused the download (HTTP 403)".
4. Press **Token Page**, then **Create new token**, type **Read**. The name is only a label for you, such as "LTX Alpha Gen download". Copy the token. It starts with `hf_`.
5. Paste it into **Hugging Face Token** and press Return.
6. Check the **Model Folder**. The default is `~/LTX-2.5`. If you already have some of the model files, for example in a ComfyUI folder, set **Existing Models** to that folder: matching files are checked and copied instead of downloaded. Tick **Link Existing Models** to link to them instead of copying them, which saves up to 73 GB, as long as that folder stays available.
7. Press **Download**. A window shows the progress. It installs its own Python and everything the model needs into the Model Folder, then downloads the models and checks every file.

Keep every file in the Model Folder, including the `.verified` ones, which are Setup's record that a model was checked.

The buttons open these pages:

- https://huggingface.co/Lightricks/LTX-2.5

- https://huggingface.co/Lightricks/LTX-2.5-22b-IC-LoRA-Alpha-Gen
- https://huggingface.co/settings/tokens

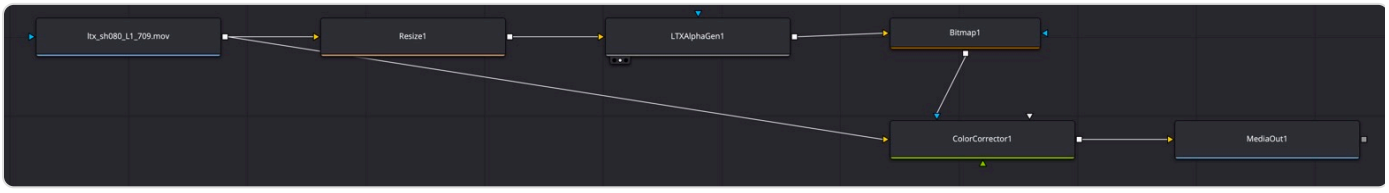
> **Keep your token private.** With it, someone can download anything your account can. The plugin uses it for this download only and never stores it: the field clears as soon as Download starts. Once the models are on every Mac, you can revoke it on the same page. If you record your screen, blur it or use a throwaway token.

Once Setup is complete, these controls hide themselves. Tick **Show Setup Options** to bring them back.

Your first matte

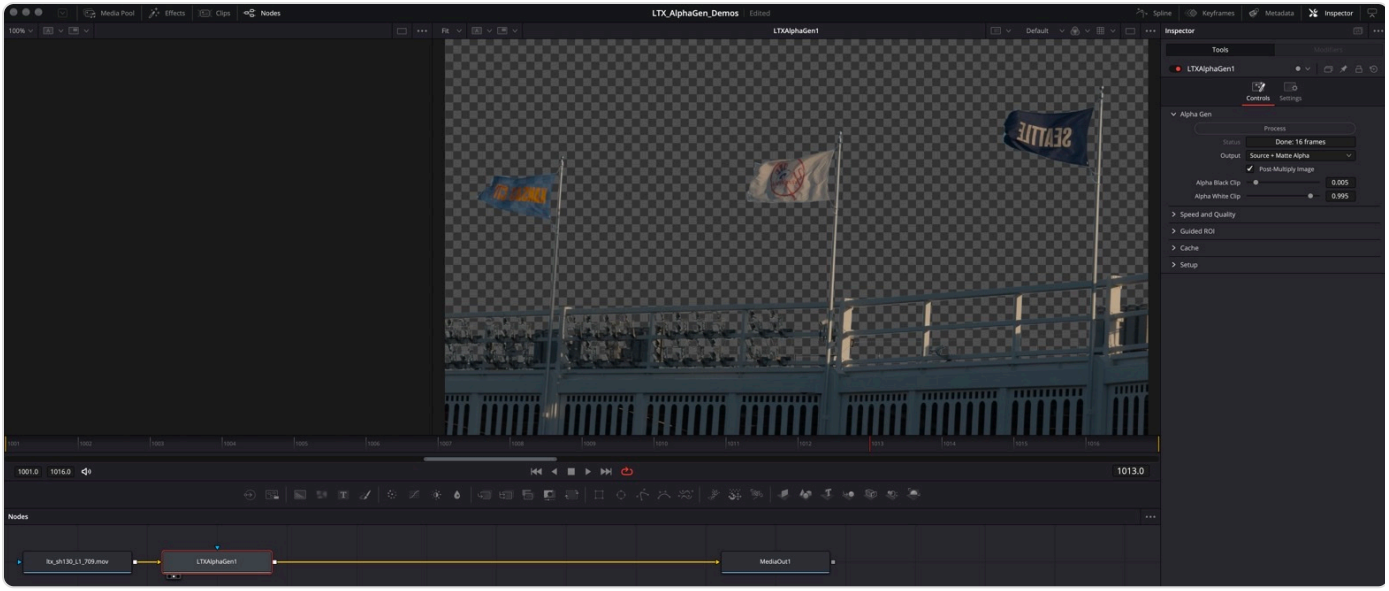
Work on the Fusion page or in Fusion Studio, in HD:

```
MediaIn1 (or Loader) → Resize 1920×1080 → LTX Alpha Gen → Bitmap (Channel: Alpha) → mask
```



The node tree for grading the subject: the clip goes through Resize and LTX Alpha Gen to a Bitmap, which is the effect mask on a ColorCorrector on the original clip

1. **Press Process.** The host pauses for a couple of seconds while it hands over the frames, then the job runs on its own with a progress window and Cancel. Status follows it, and the viewer updates when it is done.
2. **Check it.** Set **Output** to **Overlay** to see the matte in magenta over the picture, or **Matte** to see the matte itself. Changing Output needs no reprocessing.
3. **Use it.** A **Bitmap** node (Channel: Alpha) turns the matte into a mask, and masks scale to whatever they are applied to, so it works on the full-resolution picture.



The Fusion page after Process: the flags and stands kept over a checkerboard, with Done in Status

To grade the subject: take the Bitmap into a ColorCorrector's effect mask on the original MediaIn.

To cut it out: use a MatteControl with the original as Background and the Bitmap in Garbage Matte, with Invert on, then a Merge over a new background.

Why HD?

Two limits decide what a Mac can process at once: memory, and a limit in macOS's GPU framework. That makes 73 frames per chunk the practical maximum at HD, and UHD only fits for very short clips, about 17 frames. So put a Resize before the node and use the matte as a mask on the full-resolution picture, or use Guided ROI.

Feed it Rec.709

The model expects normal Rec.709 video, and the plugin passes on the pixels as they arrive. Log footage still gives a good matte, but in a side-by-side test on one shot, the matte from a Rec.709 picture was better. So convert before the node, and use the matte on your untouched footage:

```
source → Color Space Transform (log to Rec.709) → LTX Alpha Gen → matte to the original branch
```

Choosing the subject: Guided ROI

There is no text prompt: the model picks the main subject of what it sees. To choose the subject, give the picture coming in an alpha, such as a loose Magic Mask, roto or garbage matte. It does two things:

- **Where the model looks.** The model only sees a crop around the area the alpha covers over the whole clip, plus a margin. That is much faster, and better for small subjects. A mask that sweeps across half the frame makes a big crop, and the model may keep more than you want inside it.

- **What you keep. Multiply by Input Alpha** (on by default) trims the matte to your mask, instantly.

A tight crop is the biggest speed-up there is: in one test, about 8 times faster per frame than full HD. The setup that works best keeps the real picture inside the crop, so the model makes the edges itself:



The Guided ROI node tree: the clip goes to the MatteControl's Background, and through MagicMask and ErodeDilate to its Foreground, then on to LTX Alpha Gen

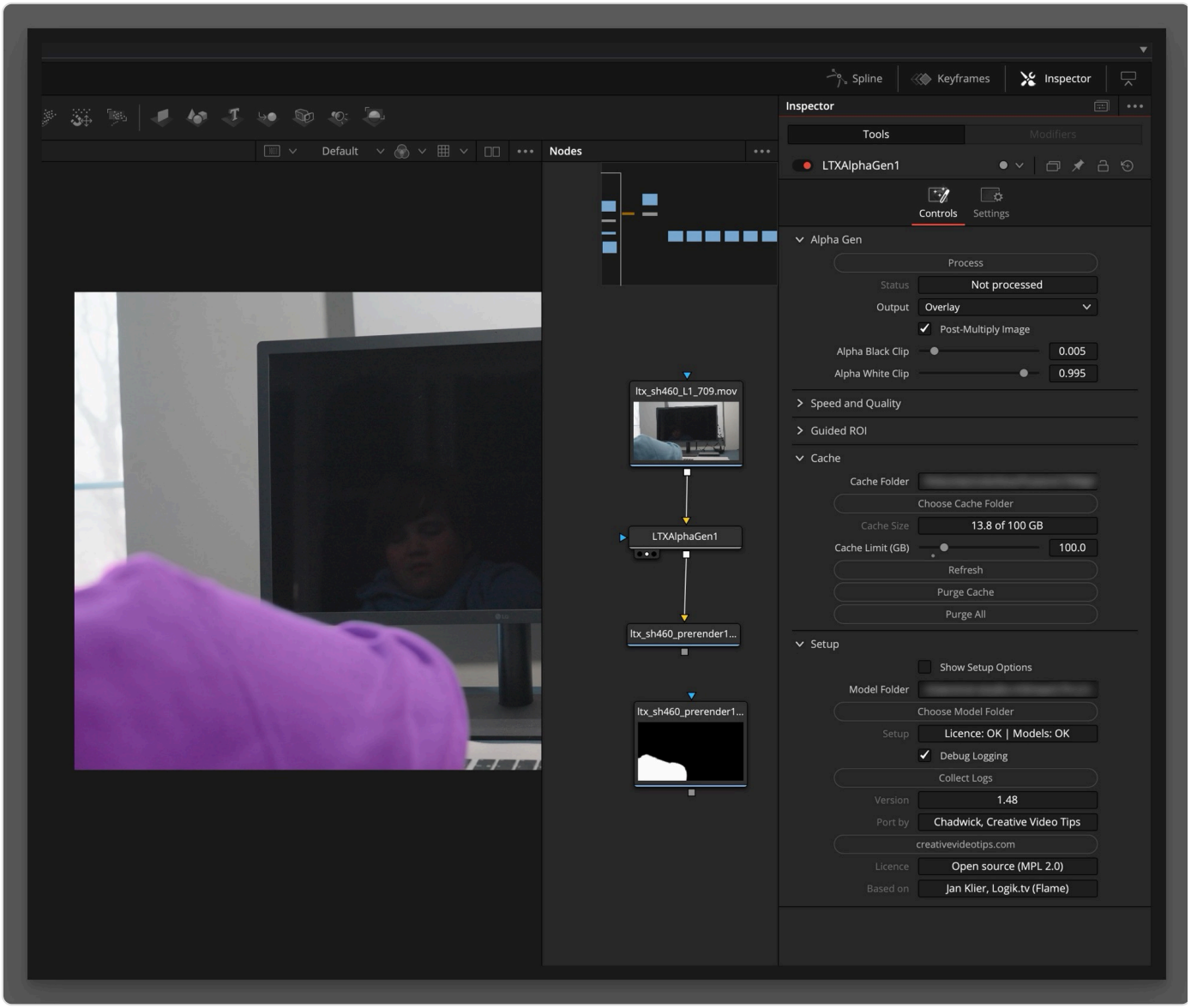
1. **Magic Mask the subject.** An **ErodeDilate** grown a few pixels puts the mask's edge just outside the subject, so LTX's edge decides the outline.
2. **Add a MatteControl.** Background = the original picture, Foreground = the mask. Matte: Combine **Combine Alpha**, Combine Op **Copy**, **Post-Multiply Image off**, so the picture isn't blacked out.



3. **Press Process. Model Crop** shows the crop size, for example "Crop 1280x1024".

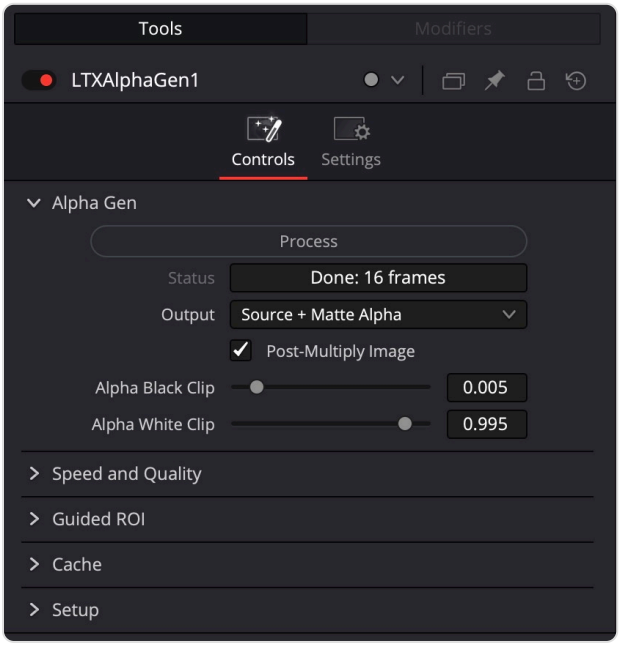
A small subject in a UHD shot can be processed at full resolution this way, without the Resize, as long as the crop is no bigger than about an HD frame in area.

The controls



The Fusion page with the node in the Inspector, Output on Overlay showing the matte in magenta, and the Cache and Setup sections open

Alpha Gen

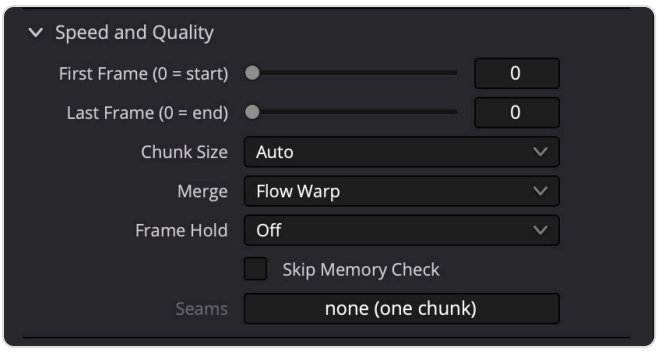


Control	What it does
Process	Makes mattes for every frame of the comp, or the render range in Fusion Studio.
Status	What the node is doing, or why it stopped.
Output	**Source + Matte Alpha** (default): the picture with the matte in its alpha. **Matte**: the matte in RGB and alpha. **Overlay**: the picture with the matte in magenta.
Post-Multiply Image	On (default): the picture is multiplied by the matte, ready for a Merge. Off: the picture untouched.
Alpha Black Clip	Matte values at or below it become 0 (default 0.005). This clears the faint haze the model leaves in the background.
Alpha White Clip	Matte values at or above it become 1 (default 0.995), so the inside of the subject is solid. Soft edges stay soft.

Only Process needs the model. The rest change instantly.

Speed and Quality

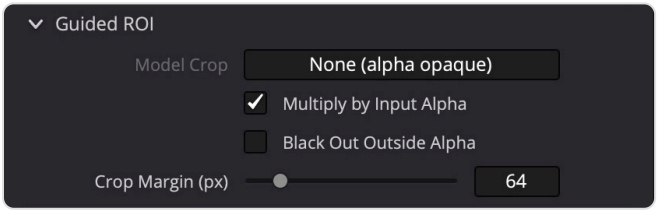
The defaults are fine for most shots.



Control	What it does	When to change it
First Frame, Last Frame	Resolve only: process just these frames. 0 means from the start or to the end.	To try a short section first. Resolve's yellow render range bars don't limit Process.
Chunk Size	**Auto**, **Half (73)** or **Quarter (33)** frames per model run. Auto picks the longest that fits: up to 145 frames for small pictures, 73 at HD.	Leave it on Auto. Shorter chunks need less memory, but join at more seams.
Merge	How chunks join where they overlap. **Flow Warp** (default) lines up moving edges so they slide instead of doubling. **Dissolve** is a plain cross-dissolve.	Try Dissolve if Flow Warp ever smears an edge at a seam.
Seams	Read-only: the frames where the last Process joined two chunks.	Check moving edges there with Output on Matte.
Frame Hold	**Off**, **2x** or **4x**: repeats each frame so the model sees less motion per step, for sharper edges and a more solid core. Takes about 2x or 4x as long.	Leave it Off for most shots. Try 2x on a final shot with fast motion, such as a running leg. 4x is rarely worth it.
Skip Memory Check	Processes even when the memory estimate says the clip won't fit.	The estimate is cautious, so it may work. If not, macOS swaps to disk and the job slows down badly or fails, but nothing is damaged.

Precision isn't something you set. The model runs in a 16-bit format chosen for your chip, and your pictures stay in float.

Guided ROI



Control	What it does
Model Crop	The crop the model saw at the last Process.
Multiply by Input Alpha	Trims the matte to the input alpha. Instant. On by default.
Black Out Outside Alpha	Blacks out the picture outside the alpha before the model sees it, so it can't pick anything else. The edges then follow your mask. Needs Process.
Crop Margin	Extra pixels of context around the alpha's area (default 64). Raise it if the matte is cut off in a straight line at the crop edge. Needs Process.

Cache

Mattes are kept on disk, about 4 MB per HD frame, and renders reuse them. A real change before the node, such as a grade, the Resize, a trim or another clip, needs a new Process.

- **Purge Cache** deletes this node's mattes, and **Purge All** deletes every node's.
- **Cache Limit** (default 50 GB, about 12,000 HD frames) is the most the cache may grow to. The least recently used mattes go first, and mattes unused for 30 days are deleted too. A deleted matte only costs a Process.
- **Refresh** is rarely needed. If the viewer still shows MAKING MAGIC after a job has finished, it picks up the new mattes without reprocessing.

Check your renders

> **MATTE MISSING can end up in your render.** On the **Fusion page and in Fusion Studio**, a render stops at the first frame with no matte that it has to draw. But frames you have already viewed in this session can be saved with the text in them, and a Deliver made up only of such frames reports Complete. On the **Edit and Color pages**, a Deliver always carries the text on those frames and reports Complete. So process the whole range you are rendering, and check the result, including the frames of any render that stopped.

Edit and Color pages

The plugin also works as an effect on these pages.

- **Adding it:** on the Edit page, drag it onto the clip, or select the clip and double-click the effect. On the Color page, drag it onto a node.
- **Frames:** these pages count edit frames from 0, while the Fusion page counts source frames, usually from 1001.

- **After a job:** if the viewer still says MAKING MAGIC or shows an old picture, move the playhead one frame.
- **While a job runs on the Color page:** the viewer shows the picture rather than MAKING MAGIC. The progress window and Status show that it is running.
- **To see the matte on the Color page:** set Output to Overlay or Matte.
- **Log footage on the Color page:** put the node after one that converts to Rec.709.

> **Remote grades:** a node on the Color page goes into the clip's grade. With a remote grade, that changes the clip on every timeline sharing it. To try the plugin, switch the clip to a local version first.

Slow-motion clips

The Fusion page works on source frames, not edit frames. A clip shot at 120 fps in a 24 fps timeline has about 5 source frames per edit frame: a 21-frame clip was 101 frames to process. Check the frame count in Status, and use First Frame and Last Frame to try a section first.

Mattes from an earlier First/Last Frame range stay in the cache, but two ranges processed separately aren't blended where they meet. For a finished shot, process the whole shot at once.

On a 64 GB Mac

64 GB Macs are not recommended. If you try one anyway, use Fusion Studio with nothing else open. It leaves about 45-49 GB for the model, against about 39 GB in Resolve, where the memory check stops HD jobs. Keep Fusion Studio's own memory setting (Preferences > Memory) at the default 80% or lower, so a heavy comp doesn't take the model's room.

When something looks wrong

What you see	What it means	What to do
NOT PROCESSED	The node has no mattes yet.	Press Process.
MAKING MAGIC	A job is running.	Wait. If it stays after the job finished, move the playhead or press Refresh.
MATTE MISSING	This frame has no matte: outside the processed range, or purged.	Process this range.
PICTURE CHANGED	The picture coming in has changed since Process.	Press Process again.
SETUP REQUIRED	The licence or models aren't ready.	Finish Setup.

What you see	What it means	What to do
Apple's Command Line Tools are missing	Download can't start without them.	Run `xcode-select --install` in Terminal, then press Download again.
Hugging Face refused the download (HTTP 403)	One page's terms weren't accepted, or the token is wrong.	Accept the terms on both pages and check the token.
Too large for this Mac's memory	The estimate says the clip won't fit.	Resize to HD, use Guided ROI, or try Skip Memory Check.
Render did not complete	A Saver reached a frame with no matte.	Process the whole range.
The matte is on the wrong subject	The model picked its own main subject.	Use Guided ROI.
The matte is cut off in a straight line	It hit the edge of the crop.	Raise Crop Margin and press Process.
Edges double on fast motion	Too much motion per frame.	Try Frame Hold 2x.
The matte jumps partway through	A seam between two chunks.	Check the frames under Seams with Output on Matte. Try the other Merge, or Guided ROI.

Two limits to know about: long clips are made in chunks, and the model may pick a slightly different subject in each. Repeat runs can also differ slightly: the first chunk repeats exactly, but later chunks can differ a little, mostly at the edges.

Need help? Collect Logs in Setup writes a support bundle with logs and system details to your home folder. It has no images and no token, but it does have your folder paths, so read it before you send it.

Uninstall

Delete these. The last three hold the models, mattes and settings.

- `/Library/OFX/Plugins/LTXAlphaGen.ofx.bundle`
- `~/LTX-2.5` (or your Model Folder)
- `~/.cache/ltx-alphagen` (and your Cache Folder, if you changed it)
- `~/.config/ltx-alphagen`

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v1.00: first guide.

v1.01: adds screenshots of the controls and node setups, and a hair example.

v1.02: says it needs macOS 15 or later, which the installer now checks.

v1.03: the Model Folder now starts at ~/LTX-2.5.

v1.04: adds Link Existing Models.

v1.05: not recommended on 64 GB Macs or smaller.

v1.06: adds a screenshot of the whole node in the Fusion page.